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Built Heritage Statement

Land at South Marston
Swindon Eastern Villages

April 2014

Planning • Heritage

Specialist & Independent Advisors to the Property Industry

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 This built heritage statement has been prepared by CgMs Consulting on behalf of Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey and Hannick Homes, to consider the potential effects on the historic built environment of the residential development of land at South Marston, Wiltshire. It has been produced as an addendum to ES Chapter 10: Historic Environment of the Environmental Statement for the Outline Planning Application for Land at South Marston and Rowborough, Swindon New Eastern Villages.

1.2 The purpose of this addendum is to expand on the built heritage appraisal undertaken in the Environmental Statement in order to take account of comments made by English Heritage on the 7th January 2014 and Swindon Borough Council. In particular, the need to expand the study area has been taken into account, resulting in a new site survey which included the historic core of the village, as well as heritage assets to the south of the Proposed Development Site. The second site survey also included an appraisal of above ground non-designated heritage assets as discussed and agreed with the Swindon Borough Council Conservation Officer, in order to assess the effect of the Proposed Development upon them. Consideration of the buried historic environment is not dealt with in this statement. In addition, the legislative framework has not been discussed within this addendum, as it has been covered by the original Environmental Statement, however all relevant heritage requirements of the National Policy Planning Framework and local policy have been considered in producing this statement.

1.3 The key objectives for this assessment remain the same as in the previous study, namely to:

- Assess the potential effect of construction of the Proposed Development on known and potential heritage assets and to evaluate the significance of the effect;
- Assess the effects of the Proposed Development following its completion, on heritage assets including consideration of their settings; and
- Identify measures for avoiding or mitigating potential effects; and detail residual effects following suggested mitigation

1.4 The significance criteria for the assessment are also the same as in the original Environmental Statement and are laid out in Tables 10.1; 10.2 and 10.3 in Chapter 10 of the Environmental Statement.

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2.0 BUILT HERITAGE ASSESSMENT

2.1.1 Designated Heritage Assets

2.1.2 There are no designated heritage assets within the Site. The Site is, however, within the wider settings of eight listed buildings (Fig. 1).

St Mary Magdalen Church

2.1.3 St Mary Magdalen Church is listed Grade I and is located to approximately 150 metres to the north-west of the Site boundary. The church is listed as being of architectural and historic interest, with the listing citation noting that it is a:

Small mediaeval parish church with west tower. Built of rubble with ashlar quoins and dressings. Stone tile roof. Crenellated parapet to nave. Four bay aisleless nave, mostly in Perpendicular style with flat headed 2-light windows; contemporary south porch retaining one pinnacle above a diagonal buttress and sundial over entrance.

2.1.4 In addition, the church contains some medieval fabric with twelfth-century doors, which were taken from an earlier church, and a thirteenth century chancel. It has a fifteenth-century, two stage, crenelated tower with (probably nineteenth-century) corbelled diagonal pinnacles.

2.1.5 The asset's immediate setting consists of the churchyard, with a small cemetery to the south, which includes a number of mature trees. The heritage asset is confined on three sides by modern infill housing development, with only its aspect to the north remaining open. However it does also have an aspect to the east of Church Farm. The crenelated tower is a recurring view throughout the Site with glimpsed views from Nightingale Lane and the Red House. However, the surrounding residential development as well as the hedge lines in the Site mean that only the top of the tower and in some cases only the pinnacles can be seen.

2.1.6 The Church is a heritage asset of high sensitivity, which is reflected by its Grade I listing. Its primary value derives form its architectural and historic interest, with its immediate setting (churchyard) also contributing to its value. Its wider setting, which includes glimpsed views of the Church tower, is of secondary importance to the heritage asset's value, with views of the tower from within the Site and village still providing a historical link to the parish church.

Church Farm

2.1.7 This built heritage asset is designated Grade II and is located 100 metres to the north-east of the Site boundary and to the east of St Mary Magdalen Church. The asset, which is an early

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nineteenth-century farmhouse, is listed as being of architectural and historic interest, with the list entry noting that it has:

Two storeys. Painted brick with chamfered quoins. Hipped slate roof. Three windows, glazing bar sashes in raised surrounds. Projecting pentice porch. Two storey extension to rear.

2.1.8 The immediate setting of the asset consists of two agricultural buildings to the north, which positively contribute to the asset's value, with modern residential buildings beyond. There is a large enclosed garden to the south. The asset is surrounded by vegetation which means that there is little intervisibility from the asset to the Site. However the asset's main aspect is to the south-east with open fields which make a positive contribution to the asset's value.

2.1.9 The building is a heritage asset of moderate (regional) sensitivity which is reflected by its formal designation as Grade II. However the wider setting of the building is mixed. The open fields to the south-east make a positive contribution to the asset's value, while the sight-line to the medieval church also makes a positive contribution to the building's setting. However there is a bank of twentieth century residential development to the south-west which screens any further views in that direction and make a negative contribution to the asset's setting. However, the asset's value derives primarily from its architectural and historic interest and not from its setting.

Manor Farm

2.1.10 Manor Farm is designated Grade II and is located towards the eastern boundary of the Site. Although the heritage asset is surrounded by the Site it does not fall within the application boundary. The asset is listed as late seventeenth or early eighteenth century and has been designated due to its architectural and historic interest. In addition the listing citation notes that the building has:

Two storeys and attic. Rubble. Stone slate roof, hipped to right hand return. Central hipped dormer. Three windows, two light casements with wood lintels and glazing bars; central modern glazed door. Right hand return has two windows, one an old cross mullion casement and a projecting hipped stair turret with block windows in angle and an early-mid nineteenth century extension.

2.1.11 The farmhouse lies on the northern side of a large farm complex with gardens to the west and a gravel driveway to the east, with this complex forming the asset's immediate setting. The complex includes a twentieth-century cart shed and garage, as well as a high Victorian barn and some agricultural ancillary buildings, as well as some earlier buildings. However these assets will be considered separately below. The wider setting of the farmhouse is dominated

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by its main aspect, to the east, which includes a small paddock and some ancillary buildings, with views across the Site beyond. In addition, to the north-east of the asset, there are views of the modern built area and part of the historic core of the village, and the view to the north west is dominated by a modern industrial building.

2.1.12 The building is a heritage asset of moderate sensitivity due to its formal designation. Its immediate setting, which includes the farm complex, makes a positive contribution to the value of the building through the provision of historic and visual context. The modern fields which lie to the north-east of the asset also make a similar positive contribution to the value of the asset. In addition the modern development, both residential and industrial, to the north and east of the asset make a negative contribution to the asset's value. This is because the encroachment of modern development has partially eroded the functional link between the Farmhouse and the surrounding agricultural land. However, the asset is designated for its historical and architectural interest, therefore its setting is of secondary importance to the asset's value, but does still provide historical context, thorough the link with the surrounding agricultural land.

Nightingale Farmhouse

2.1.13 This heritage asset is designated as Grade II and is located at the far north-east of the Site, 20 metres from the Site boundary, at the top of Nightingale Lane. It is an early nineteenth century farmhouse and the listing citation notes that it has:

Two storeys and mansard. Red and blue brick with brick dentil eaves cornice. Four windows to garden, two light casements (outer three light). Gabled wooden porch off-centre left. Later wall chimney to rear. Mansard slate roof with gable end brick chimneys. 'L' plan later extension to rear.

2.1.14 The asset is situated to the south of a large farm complex which consists mainly of modern agricultural buildings. The main aspect of the asset is to the east, with an enclosed garden giving way to a large modern field. Directly to the south of the asset is a large modern agricultural field which is screened from the asset by numerous mature trees. A forest to the north of the asset screens any views.

2.1.15 The heritage asset is of moderate sensitivity, with its value deriving primarily from its historical and architectural interest. However the immediate setting of the asset, including the associated agricultural buildings does positively contribute to the value of the asset, through the provision of agricultural context. In addition the fields to the east make a similar positive contribution to the asset's value.

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The Priory

2.1.16 The Priory is a Grade II listed farmhouse situated on the border of the south-west of the Site boundary. It is located to the north of the railway line and to the east of Thornhill Road. The Priory is mid seventeenth century and the list citation states that it has:

Two storeys and gable lit attic. Rubble with stone tile roof. Large chimney off centre left with three now breeze-block diagonal shafts. Three ranges of late C19 sash windows. Modern casement lintels. Traces on first floor to right of former three-light mullion window surround. Modern lean-to porch off-centre right.

2.1.17 The immediate setting of the Priory contains three large agricultural buildings to the west of the farmhouse, with a large garden to the east and south, however any views beyond this are terminated to the south by the railway embankment and a screen of trees. The main aspect of the asset looks directly east across open fields to a hedgerow which prevents any views through to South Marston Farm. Similarly mature trees prevent the northward view of Wythburn. However, while the mature planting terminates views of the railway line to the south, a large modern office complex is clearly visible above the tree line.

2.1.18 The Priory is a moderately sensitive heritage asset, with its primary value deriving from its historic and aesthetic value. In addition it also has a strong historical association with Alfred Williams, the local poet, who briefly worked on the farm. Although its setting of secondary importance to the asset's value, it does provide agricultural context. However, the agricultural buildings which make up the Site as well as the main aspect across the field to the north-east and east positively contribute to the setting and therefore the value of the asset. The modern office complex to the south of the asset negatively contributes to the asset's value.

The Red House

2.1.19 This heritage asset is listed as Grade II and similarly to Manor House is surrounded by the Site, though not included within the Site boundary. The asset is early nineteenth century and is listed for its historic and architectural interest. The listing citation states that the asset has:

Two storeys and gable lit attic. Rubble with red brick front with brick block eaves cornice. Brick quoins. Two ranges of 3 light casements and central modern gabled porch. Stone tile roof with gable end brick chimneys.

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2.1.20 The Red House is situated in an isolated position facing the south-west. Its immediate setting consists of a garden to the rear (south) and the east. The asset is surrounded by modern agricultural fields, which make up its wider setting and provide a view of Manor Farm to the west. To the north the modern built up area of South Marston can be seen, while views to the east are restricted by mature trees within the hedge lines.

2.1.21 The asset is of moderate sensitivity, with its primary value deriving from its historic form and fabric, while its immediate garden surroundings also positively contribute to the value of the Red House. The surrounding modern fields make a positive contribution to the asset's value through reinforcing the sense of seclusion. However the view to Manor Farmhouse is incidental and therefore makes a neutral contribution to The Red House's value.

Longleaze Farm

2.1.22 This heritage asset is listed as Grade II and is located 50 metres to the south of the Site, with the railway line, which follows the line of the Wilts and Berks Canal, and the A420 divorcing the asset from the Site, while the railway embankment ensures that there is no intervisibility between the asset and the Proposed Development Site. However the presence of this infrastructure may give evidential value, as it is likely that the Farm was constructed close to the Canal and Road to provide transport links. The asset is an eighteenth century thatched farmhouse and the listing citation notes that it has:

Centre rubble, sides brick, all painted. Half-hipped roof with two brick chimneys. One and a half storeys. Four dormers cut into thatch. Four windows. All casements. Thatched porch in left hand wing. Lower rubble extension to right with hipped roof.

2.1.23 The asset is situated to the east of a large farm complex, which contains a number of modern agricultural buildings. This complex forms the asset's immediate setting, with the asset's main aspect towards the south, away from the road. The northern aspect of the asset is dominated by a screen of trees, used to conceal the A420 beyond.

2.1.24 This asset is of moderate sensitivity and while the presence of the local infrastructure provides evidential value, it also screens intervisibility between the asset and the Site. The asset's value derives primarily from its historic and architectural interest, with the immediate setting and link with local agricultural buildings contributing positively to this value.

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Marston Farmhouse

2.1.25 Marston Farmhouse is listed as Grade II and is located 100 metres to the south of the Site. It is situated between the A420 to the south and the railway line to the north, meaning that there is no intervisibility between the Site and the asset. The asset is an eighteenth century farmhouse with the listing citation stating that it has:

Two storeys. Rubble with slate roof. 'U'-plan, north wing nineteenth century with lean-to open passage. East front has brick repairs. Four windows, irregular, on first floor, three on ground floor. Two doors, to through-passage. Main entrance at rear.

2.1.26 The immediate setting of the asset is enclosed, with three large agricultural ancillary buildings to the west and a large tree lined garden to the east. The wider setting of the asset is dominated by infrastructure developments; as it is framed by the railway to the north, the A420 to the south, and a large modern office complex to the west. Any possible views to the west of the Site across the modern open fields are obstructed by the tree screen which continues around the boundary of the garden.

2.1.27 This asset is of moderate sensitivity with the immediate setting of agricultural buildings positively contributes to the value of the asset. The wider setting of the agricultural fields to the east and west positively contribute to the value of the asset through the provision of agricultural context, while the heavy screening to the south which blocks views of the A420, ensures that this aspect makes a neutral contribution. In addition the railway embankment and tree screening means that there is no intervisibility between the asset and the Site.

2.2.1 **Non-designated heritage assets**

2.2.2 There is one non-designated heritage asset within the Site (Rowborough Farm), while a number of other designated heritage assets lie outside of the Site boundary, but within the vicinity of the Proposed Site.

Rowborough Farm

2.2.3 Rowborough Farm is a large nineteenth century farmhouse which is located within the Site boundary, east of its centre. It consists of a three storey range with two, two storey ranges and a one storey building to the front. The main building is due to be retained in the development. The primary setting of the building consists of the agricultural buildings which surround the farmhouse, however these are all modern agricultural buildings. This means that the immediate setting does positively contribute to the value of the building through providing a functional link. The wider setting is made up of a view of a track in the near distance to the

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east, with modern agricultural fields beyond, which makes a positive contribution to the value of the asset, through the provision of agricultural context. The view to the south is of a modern paddock, with Rowborough Lane beyond, which also makes a similar positive contribution to the asset's value.

Buildings Associated with Alfred Williams

2.2.4 As a famous resident of South Marston, Alfred William's connection to some buildings within the village, means that they can be described as non-designated heritage assets of local importance through historical association. These include Alfred's birthplace, **Cambria Cottage**, as well as **Rose Cottage** and **Dryden Cottage**, where he lived during his life. All of these are located within the core of the historic village, which has become increasingly built up with twentieth century infill residential development. This means that there is no intervisibility between the assets and the Site. In addition, as the assets are primarily notable for their historical association, any changes in setting will have a negligible effect on their local value.

Schoolhouse

2.2.5 In addition the Schoolhouse (South Marston Church of England Primary School) is a locally important heritage asset which is also associated with Alfred Williams. It is located 100 metres to the north-east of the Site boundary. The school was opened in 1873, with Alfred attending between 1882 and 1888. The asset is a Victorian, Gothic schoolhouse, which has been significantly extended to the rear, with numerous additions being made in the post-war period. The immediate setting of the building is made up of the main schoolhouse and the ancillary school rooms, with the playground surrounding the school and green open space to the south. The asset's main aspect to the east includes a view of the church, which positively contributes to the setting of the asset, however views to the south are largely obstructed by the ancillary school buildings. The building is of low sensitivity with its value deriving from its historical association and architectural merit, meaning that any change to the setting of the asset would have a negligible effect on its value.

Oxleaze Farm

2.2.6 This building is an eighteenth century two storey farmhouse constructed from red brick, with a significant rubble extension to the west end. It is situated 100 metres to the west of the Site boundary. The asset's immediate setting consists of agricultural buildings, with a large surrounding garden. Its wider setting consists of two fields to the east and south with no intervisibility beyond due to screening from trees. The immediate setting makes a positive

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contribution to the asset's value, while the wider setting of the fields beyond make a positive contribution, through the provision of agricultural context.

South Marston Farm

2.2.7 South Marston Farmhouse is a locally important, non-designated heritage asset, located 50 metres south of the Site boundary and to the east of The Priory. It was delisted in 1994. The asset is an eighteenth century farmhouse. However it has been significantly altered. The asset consists of two, two storey ranges and one single storey range. The two storey ranges have half hipped roofs, with the main range also possessing photo-voltaic cells. The farmhouse is set in a small cluster of mixed use buildings, with both residential and agricultural units present. The wider setting consists of a view to the east from the main aspect of the asset across modern agricultural fields. It is noticeable that the fields in this part of the Site have a more open appearance with lower hedgerows and fewer mature trees; however there is a large hedgerow which intercepts the view in the far distance. The asset has been significantly altered, with its relationship to the other agricultural buildings within the immediate setting also being affected by some conversion to residential use. This also means that, while the large modern fields do make some positive contribution to the value of the asset, through demonstrating an historic functional link, this has largely been lost through the conversion of the ancillary agricultural buildings to a residential use.

Agricultural Buildings Associated with Manor Farm

2.2.8 This is a varied range of buildings located to the west of Manor Farm, all of which share a strong functional link with the Farmhouse. The buildings consist of a range of two red-brick barn structures, of eighteenth-century origin, which appear to pre-date the farmhouse itself. These buildings have both been significantly altered, with additional lean-to structures added to the buildings throughout the twentieth century. The Victorian threshing barn is also of red-brick, with a steeply pitched gabled roof of slate, as well as a projecting gabled bay. The immediate setting of all three of the buildings is defined by the farmyard itself. This setting positively contributes to the value of the buildings as it demonstrates the functional link between the buildings and also with Manor Farmhouse. In addition, the wider setting of the buildings takes in the surrounding agricultural land. Although there is limited intervisibility between the buildings and this agricultural land, there is still a strong functional link between the buildings and the land.

Manor Lodge

2.2.9 This is a late eighteenth or early nineteenth-century building, which is probably contemporary with Manor Farm. It is located 10 metres to the north of the Site boundary and is of coursed

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rubble with stone slate roof. The building is arranged in a rough L-plan, with a gable fronting Thornhill Road, with the aspect onto the road forming the immediate setting of the asset. The building has been significantly altered during the post-war period, with the insertion of a new porch and windows. There is a footpath to the south-east of the asset, which provides partial views of the Site. It is likely that this footpath may have also been an historic route between the Lodge and Manor Farmhouse. Therefore it provides a key element of the asset's setting, through the provision of evidential value, while it also enhances the visual setting of the asset, through providing partial views out of the suburban road to green space beyond.

Swindon Hotel

2.2.10 The Swindon Hotel is a local heritage asset of negligible sensitivity, situated 50 metres to the north of the centre of the Site boundary. The front range of the hotel consists of a nineteenth century frontage, which incorporates a number of different architectural styles. The frontage consists of a double height bay with pediment, dormer window and four asymmetrically arranged casement windows. The asset has subsequently undergone a number of extensions and alterations, with a post-war linking block connecting the Victorian range to a utilitarian modern block to the north. Further to this, the asset has been heavily extended to the rear, with similar twentieth century utilitarian buildings. The immediate setting of the asset consists of a range of blocks and buildings, with the Victorian front giving way to post-war buildings. In addition the rear of the hotel also has a floodlit car park. Views from within the hotel complex are limited, with heavy tree screening around the border, while the main aspect, form the Victorian frontage, faces onto residential development to the north east. The building has some value as a local heritage asset due to its unusual Victorian frontage, however drastic changes to the building and its setting mean that it has little value, and its setting does not contribute to the value of the asset.

The Carpenter's Arms

2.2.11 The Carpenter's Arms is a public house located to the south of the central part of the Site on Old Vicarage Road. The Site boundary surrounds the asset, passing 20 metres to the south. The asset consists of a nineteenth century two storey range, with a single storey projecting wing to the west (possibly eighteenth century). In addition it has a ground floor canted bay and two sash windows to second storey. The projecting wing has three sash windows arranged asymmetrically. The asset has a number of modern additions to the rear and is situated fronting Old Vicarage Road to the south, with a car park to the west. The pub is also notable for its close proximity to the railway line. The main aspect from the asset is to the south across a small field, however this view is intercepted by screening to the railway line. The Carpenter's Arms is a heritage asset of negligible sensitivity due to the modern alterations it has undergone.

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Manor Cottages

2.2.12 Manor Cottages are a series of mid nineteenth century residential buildings, in a similar style, located to the north of Old Vicarage Road on the fringes of the central part of the Development Site. They are in a Gothic style consisting of three gable ends with one fronting Old Vicarage Road. The assets are set in their own gardens, with the main aspects looking across the road to modern fields. The assets are of low sensitivity with their value deriving from their architectural form, although the presence of the agricultural fields to the west reflect their previous role as agricultural workers' cottages and provide historic context.

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3.0 POTENTIAL EFFECTS

3.1 Construction stage (Designated Heritage Assets)

3.1.1 Construction effects on designated heritage assets will be of a comparable nature to those occurring at the post-completion stage, albeit of a much shorter duration. The nature of the change in the views to or from the heritage assets considered in the assessment will not be significantly different during construction when compared with post-completion. Therefore, the predicted effects of construction activities are broadly similar to those assessed under post-completion effects (see below) and have not been repeated here.

3.2 Completion Stage (Designated Heritage Assets)

St Mary Magdalen Church

3.2.1 The Proposed Development is to the south and east of the church and will be screened by existing residential developments as well as natural screening, such as trees and hedge lines. Any buildings over two storeys may further reduce the glimpsed views of the church tower from within the Site, which can be mitigated by controlling building heights. If building heights are kept to below the existing level of residential development in the area (two storeys) there will be no visible change to the setting of the Church. Therefore the development will have a **negligible effect** on the value of the church.

Church Farmhouse

3.2.2 The important setting of this building is largely restricted to its immediate surroundings due to screening from trees and existing development. The main existing view from the asset to the south east will be maintained through maintaining green space. The only significant development will continue along the existing residential development line, meaning that there will be no material effect on the wider setting of the building. The view to the church will also be maintained. Therefore there will be a **negligible effect** on the value of the building.

Manor Farmhouse

3.2.3 The Proposed Development would lead to residential development to the north and west of the farmhouse, however this would be screened by a tree belt. Although the presence of agricultural fields to the north do add some historic context, this is limited by both the industrial development in the distance and also the fact that this aspect forms a marginal part of the building's setting. The immediate setting of the heritage asset, which consists of the

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agricultural buildings surrounding the farmhouse would remain untouched by the Proposed Development. This component of its setting makes a substantial positive contribution to the value of the asset, as the buildings have group value, which provides both aesthetic and evidential value, through demonstrating the functional link between the various agricultural buildings. In addition the primary aspect from the house, to the north-east would also remain as green space. Consequently, there will be a relatively large area of open space to the front of the house with visual links back to the existing built up area of South Marston to the north east. However there would be a large block of housing to the south and west of the building. The proposed housing will lie within an area of the setting of the Farmhouse that makes a slight positive contribution to its value, as it provides a buffer zone between the house and the industrial development beyond.. The Proposed Development will be clearly visible to the east of the house, but views of the development will be blocked by existing farm buildings to the south. Therefore, there will be a visual change to the wider landscape setting of the house, changing it from being agricultural to residential in character. This will result in some change within the setting, which would affect the agricultural setting of the Farmhouse. Consequently, there will be a small magnitude of change to the value of the farmhouse, such that, the Proposed Development will have a **moderate adverse indirect effect** on the farmhouse.

Nightingale Farm

3.2.4 The Proposed Development will include some housing in the middle distance on the main (eastern) aspect of the house. In addition there will be a new road which may also be visible in the middle distance. The main value of the house derives from its immediate setting, with the agricultural buildings making a positive contribution to the asset's value. In addition the fields to the east do make a positive contribution to the wider setting of the building. While the primary value is derived from the architectural and historic interest of the asset its wider setting does also positively contribute to the significance of Nightingale Farm. Therefore a small magnitude of change to the wider setting of the farm will result in a **minor adverse indirect effect**.

The Priory

3.2.5 There will be no residential development within the immediate or wider setting of the Priory, however there will be a new access road and roundabout installed approximately fifty metres to the north of the asset, which will therefore have an effect upon its wider setting. The roundabout and initial stretch of road will be screened by existing trees, meaning that it will have a negligible effect on the wider setting of the house. However, the large field to the north-east of the asset does positively contribute to the wider setting of the asset, and therefore the presence of the road may need to be offset by additional screening, similar to the screening which is currently present between the Priory and the railway to the south, as

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well as to the north of the asset. Although the primary value of the asset is derived from its historic and architectural interest, the surrounding agricultural land does also positively contribute to its significance. This slight harm to the wider setting of the asset would, therefore result in a **minor adverse indirect effect**.

The Red House

3.2.6 The Proposed Development in the vicinity of the Red House comprises housing to the west and south, open space to the north, east and south east and housing beyond this to the east. Streets of the development may pass to the west of the house. The development would be within the wider setting of the asset, which makes a slight positive contribution to the significance of the asset. Therefore, there will be a visual change to the wider landscape setting of the house, changing it from being agricultural to residential in character. This will result in some harm to the setting, as the functional link with the surrounding agricultural land and the sense of seclusion will be eroded. Consequently, there will be some change to the value of the farmhouse, such that, the proposed development will have a **moderate adverse indirect effect** on the farmhouse.

Longleaze Farm

3.2.7 The agricultural complex of which Longleaze is a part, will be unaffected by the proposed development. The existing road junction will form one of the main access points to the Site, however this is a marginal part of the wider setting of the asset as it is already screened from the asset by a bank of trees. The development will therefore have no effect on the immediate setting of the asset, while there will be no visual change to the wider setting, although there may be an increase in noise. This would represent a negligible effect, as the value of the asset is derived primarily from its historical and architectural interest, as well as its primary setting, meaning that a slight change to the wider setting would represent a **minor adverse indirect effect** on the asset and its value.

Marston Farm

3.2.8 The immediate setting of Marston Farm, which is made up of agricultural buildings, would not be affected by the proposed development. The wider setting, which has a slight positive effect on the value of the asset, due to modern development and infrastructure would also remain unchanged. Therefore the proposed development would have a **negligible effect**.

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3.3 Completion Stage (non-designated heritage assets)

Rowborough Farm

3.3.1 This asset is the only built heritage asset (designated or non-designated) which lies inside the Proposed Development boundary. The Proposed Development would maintain the main farmhouse, with the ancillary buildings being lost and replaced with a neighbourhood mixed use centre. Although these agricultural buildings are modern additions, they do represent a functional link and make a positive contribution to the value of the asset. There will be a clear change in both the immediate setting of the building, with the conversion of the Site from agricultural to retail (and other uses), while the wider setting will change from agricultural to residential. Therefore there will be a change to the value of the farmhouse, meaning that, the Proposed Development will have a **moderate adverse indirect effect**.

Buildings Associated with Alfred Williams

3.3.2 The wider settings of these heritage assets, which are located in the core of the historic settlement, are characterised by modern residential developments. There is no intervisibility between them and the Proposed Development Site and therefore there will be **a negligible effect** on their value, which is derived primarily from historical interest and not the assets' settings.

Schoolhouse

3.3.3 The immediate setting of this building is made up of the ancillary school buildings and school playground. The main aspect of the building to the south will remain as open green space, while the view to the historic core and the church to the north-east will be unaffected by the development. In addition the primary value of the building is derived from its historical association, with the wider setting making no contribution to the value of the building, therefore the development will have **a negligible effect** on the value of the asset.

Oxleaze Farm

3.3.4 The Proposed Development would include residential development to the north-east of the asset. There will be no change to the immediate setting of the asset. There will be a moderate effect on the wider setting of the heritage asset, which makes a positive contribution to the asset's value so there would be a **minor adverse indirect effect** on the value of the heritage asset.

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South Marston Farm

3.3.5 The Proposed Development would have no effect on the immediate setting of the heritage asset. The main aspect to the east would remain as open, modern agricultural land. There will be some residential development to the north-east of the asset. The majority of this development will be screened by an established hedgerow, however some residential development will be visible in the mid distance, which will have a negative effect on the wider setting of the asset. In addition the road in the far distance to the north will also be screened. There will be some change in the wider setting of the asset with residential development to the north-east, however the value of the asset is derived primarily from its historic form and not from this wider element of setting. Therefore the development will have a **minor adverse indirect effect** on the value of the asset.

3.3.6 **Agricultural Buildings Associated with Manor Farm**

3.3.7 The immediate setting of the buildings, which is formed by the farmyard and relationship with Manor Farmhouse, will be unaffected by the Proposed Development. Although the Proposed Development will have a limited visual effect on the assets, there will be some additional harm due to the loss of the functional link between the agricultural buildings and the surrounding land. However this is not the key element of their setting, which is instead formed by the farmyard and so therefore there will be a **minor adverse indirect effect** on the value of the assets.

Manor Lodge

3.3.8 The Proposed Development will have no effect on the immediate setting of the asset. The footpath to the south-east will remain partially open in aspect, with views from the road maintained. However, there is some residential development proposed further to the south, which will severe the link with Manor Farmhouse. This will cause some harm to the asset's significance, since this historic functional link with the Farmhouse is an important element of the asset's setting. Therefore there will be a **moderate adverse effect** on the value of the asset.

Swindon Hotel

3.3.9 The main setting of the hotel, which is dictated by the hotel extensions and car park will be unaffected by the Proposed Development. The wider setting will include residential development to the south and east. The development to the east, beyond Old Vicarage Road will continue a bank of modern residential development which characterises the view from the main aspect, while the development to the south will be screened by existing trees. Therefore

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there will be a negligible change to the setting of the asset and the development will have a **negligible effect**.

The Carpenter's Arms

3.3.10 The Proposed Development will have no effect on the immediate setting of this heritage asset. The nearest development will be in the mid distance to the north-west of the Site, which will include a new roundabout and some residential development. The setting of the building, which is characterised by its close proximity to the road and railway does not contribute to the asset's value, which is derived from its historical and architectural interest. Therefore the development will have a **negligible effect** on the value of the asset.

Manor Cottages

3.3.11 The Proposed Development will have no effect on the immediate setting of these heritage assets. There will be some residential development to the south-west which will be largely screened by an established hedgerow. The main aspect to the west will remain as green space, therefore the development will have a **negligible effect** on the value of these heritage assets, which are of low sensitivity.

3.4 Mitigation Measures and Design Considerations

3.4.1 Mitigation Measures

3.4.2 Although the development of the Site is likely to cause no direct harm and cause less than substantial harm to the value of affected individual built heritage assets, there remains some scope to reduce any harm further by the introduction of appropriate mitigation measures.

3.4.3 Temporary Mitigation Measures During Construction Phase

3.4.4 Noise and dust from construction works and associated traffic/plant movements will have potential to cause negative effects on the settings of built heritage assets and how those assets around the Site are experienced. Any such effects will be of a temporary nature and would end with the completion of the construction works. These effects can, however, be mitigated by suitable controls on working methods and working times secured by appropriately worded conditions on any planning consents. Such mitigation measures can include for the provision of appropriate screening of the Site, the cleaning of access roads to the Site, damping of soils etc during dry weather and the limiting of daily movements of traffic into and from the Site.

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3.4.5 Permanent Mitigation Measures and Design Considerations

3.4.6 Ensuring the maintenance of current building heights (single or two storey) for residential buildings in the vicinity of the Church of St Mary Magdalen will help to maintain visual links between the Site and the church tower. These glimpsed views are an important part of the church's wider setting and its relationship with the Site.

3.4.7 In addition the strengthening of screening, or development of new screening across the Development Site will help to mitigate the effect of new access roads. In particular the road to the north of The Priory, including roundabout, should be screened to reduce the effect on the wider setting of the asset. In addition the road to the east of Nightingale Farm should also be screened in order to ensure that it does not have a significant effect on the mid-distance views from the main aspect of the asset. This may be achieved both by strengthening existing screens and hedgerows and through the introduction of new hedgerows to reflect the character of those which currently exist.

3.4.8 The demolition of the buildings which make up the immediate setting of Rowborough Farm may also be mitigated by building recording. However as these are predominantly modern agricultural buildings, which are situated within the curtilage of a non-designated heritage asset this may not be necessary.

4.0 CONCLUSIONS

4.1 This built heritage statement considers the potential effects of residential development of the Site on the historic built environment in line with the relevant heritage requirements of the National Planning Policy Framework and local policy.

4.2 The statement's study area predominantly includes post-medieval buildings, many of which are agricultural, on the fringes of the Proposed Development Site. In addition the effect on the historic core of South Marston, which includes the medieval Grade I listed St Mary Magdalene church has also been considered.

4.3 The statement concludes that the development of the Site will have no direct effects on the historic built environment as the only non-designated asset within the Site (Rowborough Farm) will not be altered. In addition the likely indirect harmful effects, to the settings of the heritage assets, will be less than substantial to the value of those assets. A number of mitigation measures and design considerations have been suggested which would further reduce any harmful effects.

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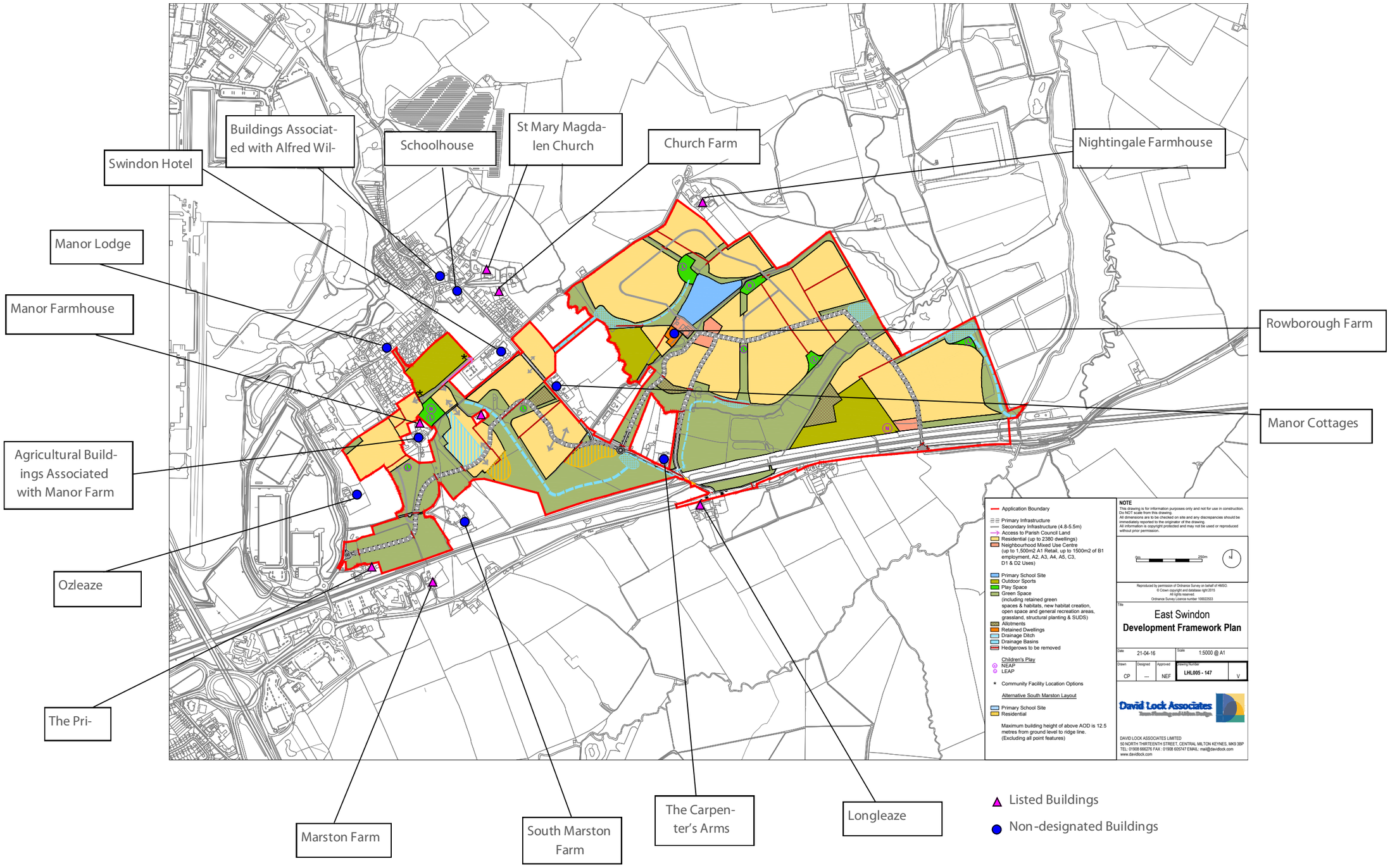

Figure 1: Site Location Plan and Location of Heritage Assets Source: David Lock Associates